

adventurers—a band of brothers and sisters—united by their own history in common purpose and common experience.

A family culture is the result of a family's history, its beliefs, its biases, its attitudes, customs, and rituals.

THE THREE “D”S

Let's look at what Elizabeth considers the primary threats the matriarch has to watch out for: the three “D”s.

Division

This is when the family divides into different factions. It could be because of a long-running disagreement. It could be because of a childhood slight or jealousy. It could be because of some sort of perceived injustice or inequality. The matriarch must be keenly aware of growing division among the children and make efforts to rectify it.

Division, of course, includes divorce. A legal divide between the matriarch and patriarch can break apart the family and is one of the most common ways for a family to lose a fortune.

Dissatisfaction

Hurt feelings can't be allowed to fester. Disappointments and sour relations between siblings or toward parents are a big danger. The matriarch must be sensitive to these sorts of feelings and make efforts to resolve them well.

Distance

Time and life changes create distance between family members, both geographic and emotional. The matriarch tries to close this distance. She keeps the lines of communication open, even when family members are far apart, organizes family reunions and meetings, and helps make sure that everyone attends. She encourages communication between family